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Assignment 3: Reflections and lessons from internship

BUSN 198R

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This summer, I worked as a remote intern at Adworthy as a social media marketer from Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m., starting the last week of June through the start of classes. I am now a part-time employee working 15 hours a week.

Adworthy is an advertising company based in New Jersey, predominantly working with private equity clients. My primary focus, though, was social planning for their AI startup, Augmetrics. Augmetrics is a sustainable AI company that has been in development for approximately 10 years and is now starting to market itself to the public.

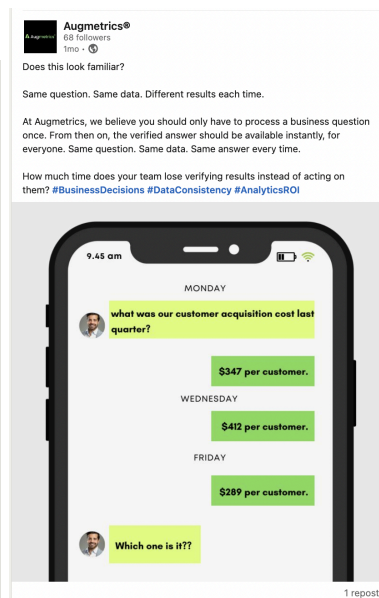
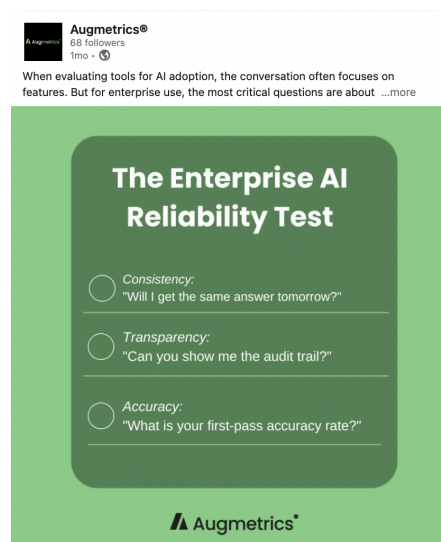
Over the summer, I collaborated with the head of Adworthy's social team to establish Augmetrics' LinkedIn presence. Given that it was a startup, I was essentially starting their profile from scratch, as they had only begun marketing their company a few weeks before I joined the team.

I began my internship with a heavy research focus, aiming to understand the intricacies of Augmetrics so I could effectively market them in the best light. This was a challenge in itself, given they were still figuring out who they were and how they wanted to be perceived as a company. Once I had completed a sufficient amount of background work, I started creating a social media plan for them, which included LinkedIn, Facebook, Twitter, and their own website. I then honed my focus specifically on the LinkedIn part, where I started to create a social

calendar. Since Augmetrics was not their only company, I often had to improvise on my own to create content because they were busy with Adworthy client work.

Drawing on content creation skills from my previous internship and my research into Augmetrics' value proposition, I developed a content strategy that addresses key concerns of enterprise buyers regarding AI reliability and cost. For example, one of my posts positioned Augmetrics' deterministic approach as a solution to the LLM consistency problem, framing their technology through questions CFOs actually ask, like "Can you show me the audit trail?" This post performed well because it spoke directly to the pain points of our target audience: enterprise decision-makers frustrated with unreliable AI outputs.

Another post tackled customer engagement using a conversational UI mockup to demonstrate how Augmetrics could handle complex queries with verifiable answers. Rather than abstract technical explanations, I used concrete, relatable scenarios that our prospects would immediately recognize from their own operations.



These posts exemplify the strategic approach I developed: leading with business problems rather than technical features, using visual storytelling to make complex AI concepts

accessible, and consistently connecting back to ROI and reliability, the two factors my research showed mattered most to Augmetrics' target market.

I had the opportunity to do extensive work in ad creation, which I hadn't done before. Specifically, I learned Meta Ad Manager from the ground up, including key insights to look for, how to create ads, measure their success, and generate reports to inform future ad strategies. This was built directly on my previous summer's experience running LinkedIn and creating content for that channel, but Meta's platform required understanding different metrics, audience targeting capabilities, and reporting structures.

While I had previously worked with optimization platforms, I hadn't worked with AI-powered tools or reporting platforms at this scale. Working with a company focused on sustainability gave me insight into the intensive issues surrounding AI's environmental impact and community resource demands, perspectives I'd never considered before viewing technology through this lens.

Working for a startup proved very different from what I expected. I found that I really had to create my own tasks and self-monitor my work, because my mentors were primarily focused on the Adworthy client side and software development, leaving limited time to assign tasks or review my submissions. I had to be proactive about identifying what needed to be done and determining how to measure my own success without constant feedback.

The startup environment was insightful in unexpected ways. I had very close communication with the CEO and senior team members, a level of access that would be impossible at a larger company. This proximity gave me visibility into strategic decision-making and allowed me to understand how early-stage companies pivot and evolve their messaging. However, this same small size meant navigating the internship largely on my own, with little

formal structure or established processes to follow. Learning to create my own framework for productivity and accountability was both challenging and valuable.

What surprised me most was how much ambiguity exists in early-stage companies. Augmetrics was still defining its brand identity and positioning throughout my internship, which meant my marketing work was constantly adapting. While initially frustrating, I came to appreciate this as realistic preparation for working in fast-paced environments where you can't always wait for perfect clarity before taking action. I learned to be comfortable making informed decisions with incomplete information, something I hadn't experienced in more structured roles.

One of the main skills this role has taught me is flexibility and independence. Unlike most internship programs that are highly structured with clearly defined tasks and dedicated supervisors, I learned how to work autonomously and maximize the value of limited face time with my bosses. When I wasn't assigned due to the team's focus on other priorities, I learned to create my own projects, and find articles or research to bring to them and self-direct my work, skills that are essential in fast-paced startup environments and increasingly valuable in any role.

I can also speak confidently about my proficiency in social media marketing and paid advertising. Through hands-on experience, I developed expertise in running Meta ad campaigns and creating LinkedIn content strategies. I learned not just how to execute campaigns, but how to analyze performance data, generate insights, and iterate based on what's working. This end-to-end understanding of digital marketing, from strategy development to execution to reporting, gives me concrete examples to share about driving measurable results.

Beyond technical skills, this internship taught me how to operate effectively in ambiguous situations. Working with a company still defining its brand identity meant I couldn't

always wait for perfect direction or clarity. I learned to make informed decisions with incomplete information, adapt quickly when strategies shifted, and communicate proactively to ensure alignment despite limited oversight. In interviews, I can point to specific examples of how I navigated this ambiguity while still delivering quality work, a skill employers increasingly value in today's dynamic business environment.

Applying the EMPAC model helped me see that the same dimensions used in retail also apply to B2B marketing. For example, my conversational UI mockup post added **entertainment** by making technical AI concepts more engaging. I used **matching** by tailoring posts to CFO concerns, like audit trails, which directly addressed their needs. By emphasizing ROI and reliability, I shaped **price perception**, while creating a content calendar across multiple channels reflected **assortment strategy**. Finally, by using simple, visual storytelling, I made complex AI ideas more accessible, which added **convenience** for busy executives. Whether selling products in stores or marketing B2B software, success requires understanding and optimizing across all five dimensions to create compelling value propositions that resonate with target customers.